

Owning a pet in the UK - Student's worksheet

Warmer

1. Look at the pictures below.
 - Can you name all the creatures you can see?
 - Do you own any of these creatures?
 - Which of the creatures are domestic pets and which are exotic pets?



What is the difference between domestic pets and exotic pets? What might you need if you buy an exotic pet?

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Task 1 – Preparation for listening

1. The words in the word cloud below are all taken from a video your teacher will show you.
 - What aspect of 'owning a pet' do you think you are going to learn about today?
 - Can you make a sentence including some of the words you can see?



Possible sentence(s)

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Task 2 – Listening

1. Your teacher will show you a video, which can be found at the following link:

<http://www.youtube.com/watch?v=FOLP8p0jSoA>

- Read through statements 1 -11 below and decide if they are true or false.
- Watch the video and see if your predictions were correct.
- If you made a sentence from the words in the word cloud, see if you can hear your sentence or any similar sentences.

1. It's always easy to own a pet.
2. Before you buy a pet, it is important to think about whether or not you can provide it with what it needs and whether your home would be a suitable environment.
3. Cats should not be kept next to a very busy road.
4. Rabbits don't need much space.
5. Dogs like to be kept inside a lot.
6. An animal owner is responsible for their pet for the rest of its life.
7. Animals need fresh food and water every week.
8. It's cheap to own an animal.
9. Vets bills can be very expensive.
10. All animals like to be kept with other animals.
11. Some animals are very hard to look after.

2. When you have finished, discuss the following questions with a partner:

- Do you, or does anyone you know, own a pet?
- What, in your opinion is the hardest thing about owning a pet?
- What else do you need to think about before you decide to own a pet?

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Task 3 – Reading: The Animal Welfare Act

The Animal Welfare Act (2006) prevents people from being cruel to animals. It also ensures that pet owners have a legal responsibility to make sure they meet the welfare needs of their pet. You can find information about the Act here <http://www.defra.gov.uk/publications/2011/03/29/pb12460-animal-welfare-act/>

- Think of five needs that all pets have and write them below.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

- Now walk around the classroom to find out what the Animal Welfare Act states are the needs of animals. Write them below.

1. _____

2. _____

3. _____

4. _____

5. _____

- Were your ideas correct?

- ## Task 5 – Discussion

- Do you think it is important to have a law to protect animals? Why?
- Do you have a similar law in your country?
- The Animal Welfare Act states that anyone who wants to buy an animal must be at least 16 years old – do you think this is a good idea?
- What do you think should happen to people who are cruel to animals or do not meet the needs of their pets?

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Extension

Choose an animal you would like to have as a pet. Use the Internet to research information about the animal.

Questions you may want to think about:

- Where does the animal originate from?
- Is it a domestic or an exotic pet?
- Will I need a special licence to own it?
- What does it eat?
- Does it have any other special requirements (e.g. does it like to be kept alone or with other animals of the same kind)?
- How much space will it need and what should it be kept in?
- Is my home a suitable environment for it?
- How much will it cost to keep?
- Will it need any injections/ operations to protect it from disease?

Give a short presentation about what you found out to the rest of the class.